



MANIRAPTORAN

A type of long-armed theropod, such as *Velociraptor*.

MARSUPIAL

A mammal that gives birth to very small live young and rears them in a pouch.

MESOZOIC

The era that followed the Paleozoic. It began 240 million years ago and ended 66 million years ago, and includes the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods.

NONBIRD DINOSAUR

As modern birds are surviving dinosaurs, palaeontologists use this term to describe dinosaurs that fall outside the bird group in the family tree. These dinosaurs died out at the end of the Cretaceous.

ORNITHISCHIAN

A member of one of the two major dinosaur groups. It is also known as a "bird-hipped" dinosaur.

ORNITHOMIMID

A type of fast-running theropod with a long neck and slender legs, similar in appearance to a modern-day ostrich.

ORNITHOPOD

A type of ornithischian (bird-hipped) dinosaur. Ornithopods were plant eaters with birdlike feet. Examples of ornithopods include the hadrosaurs.

OSTEODERM

A bony plate embedded in the skin. Rows of osteoderms made up the armor of some dinosaurs and are seen in some modern animals such as crocodiles and alligators as well.

PACHYCEPHALOSAUR

A type of ornithischian (bird-hipped) dinosaur. Pachycephalosaurs were plant eaters with a thick, bony dome on the skull.

PALEONTOLOGIST

A scientist who studies fossils and other evidence of prehistoric life.

PALEONTOLOGY

The study of fossils and prehistoric life.

PALEOZOIC

The era that came before the Mesozoic. It began 541 million years ago and ended 252 million years ago.

PEDIPALPS

A pair of tiny front limbs found in some arthropods, such as spiders and scorpions.

PLESIOSAUR

A type of marine reptile with four long flippers. Some plesiosaurs had very long necks.

PRIMATE

One of a group of mammals that includes lemurs, monkeys, apes, and humans.

PROKARYOTE

Any single-celled organism, such as a bacterium, with a cell that has a simple structure and lacks a well-defined nucleus.

PTEROSAUR

A type of flying reptile that lived during the Mesozoic Era. Its wings were made of stretched skin supported by the bones of an elongated finger in each forelimb.

SAURISCHIAN

A member of one of the two major dinosaur groups. It is also known as a "lizard-hipped" dinosaur.

SAUROPOD

A type of saurischian (lizard-hipped) dinosaur. Sauropods were plant eaters that walked on all fours and had a long neck.

SCAVENGER

An animal that lives on the remains of dead creatures and scraps left behind by other animals.

SCUTE

A tough, often protective plate embedded in the skin. It has a bony base and a covering of scaly keratin.

SERRATED

A surface that is saw-toothed, like the edge of a bread knife.

SINUS

An air-filled cavity in the skull.

SPECIES

A particular type of living thing that can breed with others of its type.

STEGOSAUR

A type of ornithischian (bird-hipped) dinosaur. Stegosaurs were armored plant eaters with large plates along their back.

SYNAPSID

One of a group of vertebrates that includes mammals and their ancestors.

THEROPOD

A type of saurischian (lizard-hipped) dinosaur. Theropods were often meat eaters and bipedal. Some theropods gave rise to birds.

THYREOPHORAN

One of a group of dinosaurs that includes the armored ankylosaurs and stegosaurs.

TRACKWAY

A trail of fossilized footprints.

TROODONTID

A type of small, agile theropod.

TYRANNOSAURID

A type of large, meat-eating theropod such as *Tyrannosaurus*. Tyrannosaurids evolved in

the Late Cretaceous and had huge jaws adapted for bone-crunching bites.

ULTRAVIOLET (UV)

Electromagnetic radiation with wavelengths shorter than visible light but longer than X-rays.

VERTEBRAE

The bones forming the backbone of a vertebrate animal.

VERTEBRATE

An animal with an internal skeleton and a backbone made up of vertebrae. Dinosaurs, mammals, birds, and fish are all vertebrates.

WINGSPAN

The measurement from the tip of one wing of an animal to the tip of the other when the wings are outstretched.

ZOOPLANKTON

A tiny animal that lives in the ocean. Some zooplankton spend their whole lives floating around.

Abbreviations used in this book

cm	centimeter
°C	degrees Celsius
°F	degrees Fahrenheit
ft	foot
g	gram
in	inch
kg	kilogram
km	kilometer
kph	kilometers per hour
lb	pound
m	meter
mph	miles per hour
MYA	million years ago
oz	ounce